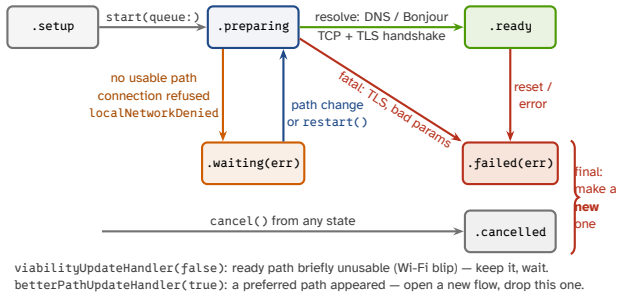
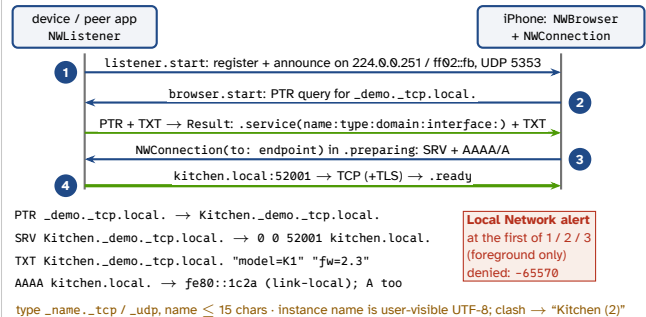


In one line: **Network.framework** (iOS 12) is Apple's socket API: an **NWConnection** is one flow driven by a **state machine** on your queue, an **NWListener** accepts flows and can **advertise** a Bonjour service, an **NWBrowser** **discovers** services as endpoints the connection resolves later. Local-network traffic is gated by the **Local Network** privacy alert (iOS 14) — with **no API to read its state**. iOS 26 adds **async** **NetworkConnection** / **NetworkListener** / **NetworkBrowser**.

NWConnection states (NWListener: same, no .preparing)



Bonjour = DNS-SD over mDNS: advertise → browse → resolve → connect



The classic API (iOS 12+)

- **NWConnection**: one flow to an **NWEndpoint** (.hostPort, Bonjour .service, .url); inert until **start(queue:)**, every handler on that queue. TCP receive returns *arbitrary chunks* — re-arm it after each; **receiveMessage** for UDP / framed.
- **NWParameters**: .tcp .udp .tls .dtls .quic(alpn:) (iOS 15). LAN knobs: **requiredInterfaceType** = .wifi, **includePeerToPeer** (AWDL: peers with no shared AP), **acceptLocalOnly** (listener).
- **NWListener**: port .any → **listener.port** once ready. Setting service advertises it (a rename shows in **serviceRegistrationUpdateHandler**); **newConnectionHandler** must start or cancel *each* connection.
- **NWBrowser**: .bonjour(type:domain:) / .bonjourWithTXTRecord; changes .added / .removed / .changed (TXT). A result is a *name*, not an IP.
- **NWProtocolFramer** (iOS 13): your framing inside the stack (**handleInput** / **handleOutput**, at **applicationProtocols[0]**). **Multicast**: **NWConnectionGroup** + **NWMulticastGroup** (iOS 14).

Example — advertise, discover, connect

```
let p = NWParameters.tcp; p.includePeerToPeer = true
let listener = try NWListener(using: p) // port: .any
listener.service = .init(name: "Kitchen", type: "_demo._tcp",
listener.newConnectionHandler = { c in c.start(queue: .main) }
let browser = NWBrowser(for: .bonjourWithTXTRecord(
type: "_demo._tcp", domain: nil), using: p)
browser.browseResultsChangedHandler = { results, _ in
guard let r = results.first else { return } // r.metadata = TXT
let c = NWConnection(to: r.endpoint, using: p) // resolves later
c.stateUpdateHandler = { if case .waiting(let e) = $0 { print(e) } }
c.start(queue: .main) }
browser.start(queue: .main)
```

iOS 26 — structured concurrency (WWDC25 session 250)

```
enum Msg: Codable { case hello(String), move(Int) }
try await NetworkListener { // result-builder stack
  Codable(Msg.self, using: .json) { TLS() } // Codable framing
}.run { conn in // child task per peer
  for try await (msg, _) in conn.messages { handle(msg) } }
let c = NetworkConnection(to: .hostPort(host: "printer.local",
port: 1029)) { TLV { TLS() } } // type-length-value
try await c.send(data, type: 1) // waits for .ready
```

Cancelled with its task. **NetworkBrowser** returns endpoints for **Bonjour** or **Wi-Fi Aware** descriptors. The old API keeps working.

Wi-Fi Aware (iOS 26)

Peer-to-peer Wi-Fi, no access point, encrypted at the Wi-Fi layer. **WiFiAware**: **pair once** (**DeviceDiscoveryUI** / **AccessorySetupKit**), then **NetworkListener** / **NetworkBrowser** .**wifiAware**(...); **Info.plist** **WiFiAwareServices**; entitlement **com.apple.developer.wifi-aware**.

Local Network privacy (iOS 14, macOS 15)

needs permission	does not
outgoing TCP to a LAN address send UDP unicast / connect UDP multicast + broadcast, both ways resolve a .local name Bonjour register / browse / resolve	listen + accept TCP receive UDP unicast non-.local names; LAN DNS / proxy WKWebView, Safari AirPlay, printing, AccessorySetupKit

Local = Wi-Fi/Ethernet subnet, multicast, broadcast, .local — not cellular or VPN.

- **States**: undetermined → alert at the **first local operation** → allowed / denied (Settings). In the **background** while undetermined: silently denied, not recorded.
- **Info.plist**: **NSLocalNetworkUsageDescription** (alert text) + **NSBonjourServices** (_demo._tcp) — the *app's* plist, even for extensions.
- **com.apple.developer.networking.multicast** (iOS, requested from Apple): raw multicast/broadcast, arbitrary or *all* service types. Declared types don't need it.
- **Denied**: browser .waiting with DNS error -65570 (PolicyDenied); connection .waiting, unsatisfiedReason .localNetworkDenied. **No status API** — infer it; trigger the alert on purpose: connect a UDP socket to a local address.
- **Background**: suspended → sockets may be reclaimed; rebuild on foreground.

Traps

- ! Tearing down on .waiting — it retries; .failed is final.
- ! "TCP delivers messages" — bytes. Length-prefix, framer, or iOS 26 TLV / Coder.
- ! TLS to kitchen.local: no public CA issues it — PSK or pin its self-signed cert.
- ! Empty browse: type not in **NSBonjourServices**, permission denied, or no **includePeerToPeer** for an AWDL-only peer.
- ! Storing the device IP — DHCP moves it. Store the *service name*; re-resolve.

Remember

"Listener advertises, browser finds names, connection resolves; the alert gates all but **accept**. Waiting retries, failed is final."